

ARCO

Funding: \$3,494 pledged of \$50,000 goal

Link: <https://dgit.in/ARCO>

While, on one hand, in-game graphics are headed towards near photorealism, there's a different appeal to AR and VR games that draws people to them - providing a sense of immersion that is unparalleled in other formats. Bringing a physical robot into the virtual world is what ARCO on Kickstarter is all about. According to Team Hicat, ARCO is a "fully immersive AR gaming and learning experience" that is part of a new generation of robotics.



At the very basic level, the ARCO doesn't look any more impressive than a regular remote-controlled toy. It stores its remote control in the storage bay of the vehicle that itself isn't any bigger than your palm. However, the real action begins when you bring your smartphone into the mix and launch the ARCO companion app.

When you point the viewfinder of the companion app at the ARCO robot, the world around it turns into a hostile alien planet, which offers evil alien robots to fight and fun puzzles in alien temples to solve. You use the remote to move and shoot, and even program the movements of the robot in the included coding mode. If that wasn't enough, ARCO's software and hardware comes with editing capabilities that will let you involve third party sensors and your own firmware and map elements into your ARCO experience.



IRL Glasses

Funding: \$131,267 pledged of \$25,000 goal

Link: <https://dgit.in/IRLglasses>

There's been a lot of discussion and coverage on how we, as a species, are more addicted to screens than ever. Even for those who are not addicted, it is difficult to avoid them when, apart from the ones in your pocket, your living room and your office, they're pretty much everywhere - in cafes, supermarkets and even in the cabs you take these days. It was in such a situation that Scott Blew decided to put polarising film to use and with his friend, Ivan Cash, developed the IRL glasses. Wear one of these and the screens at your local cafe, billboards staring at you on the road, and more, go blank. After developing a better design with improved materials, now their glasses can block most LCD and LED screens but not the latest crop of OLED screens. To snag one of these, you'd have to shell \$49 on their Kickstarter campaign. Or you could just not go to places with screens - which is going to be an increasingly difficult thing to do.

Lumapod

Funding: \$561,177 pledged of \$39,938 goal

Link: <https://dgit.in/lumapod>

When taking photos on the go, there are two major possibilities of things going wrong - either you take a wobbly, unstable shot on your camera or your tripod takes too long to unpack and you miss that crucial shot altogether. In an area that hasn't seen much innovation in recent years, Lumapod aims to bring changes as a tripod that is different. For starters, it claims to be ready to click a picture in four seconds! There's more innovation to see here too. Instead of the typical extending stick design that you see on



most tripods today, Lumapod uses patented tension technology that allows it to be really lightweight. When not being

used as a tripod, the Lumapod can also be used as a monopod or a selfie stick. To accommodate for different camera sizes, the Lumapod comes in two different variants - the Go85 and the Go120. The larger variant also supports different types of lower legs like dolly wheels, terrain levelers and even simple rubber tips. The Go85 comes with a range of accessories that have been built to make the most of shooting with smartphones and more portable cameras like the GoPro, while the Go120 packs a compact Z-plate more suited to mirrorless and DSLR cameras. Other accessories are available as add-ons through the Kickstarter. These include a Bluetooth remote, quick release plate, travel sling, compact ball head, and more.